

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

39. Given below are two statements, one is labeled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : Turkish invasions on India were successful.

Reason (R) : There was no political unity in North India.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

There are many reasons for the success of Turkish invasions in India, however, the most prominent of them was the constant warfare among the Indian rulers.

India, at that time, was divided into small kingdoms. There were many small kingdoms in North and Western India (present-day Pakistan), and this made Turk's work easy. A strong kingdom in the north would have deterred Turks.

40. Below are two statements, one of which is an Assertion (A) and the other is a Reason (R):

Assertion (A): The Turkish invasion of India was successful.

Reason (R): There was no political unity in northern India.

Choose the correct answer from the options given below :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
- (c) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

Several Turkish rulers, including Mahmud of Ghazni and Muhammad Ghori, invaded northern India between the 11th and 12th centuries. Among these, Ghori's invasion had a more significant impact, leading to the establishment of the Delhi Sultanate, which laid the foundation for Muslim rule in India. During this period, the political conditions in India were highly fragmented, with many small and independent states. Due to this lack of unity, it was easy for the invaders to achieve victory and establish control. There was no unified resistance against them.

Thus, both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) correctly explains (A).

Delhi Sultanate: Slave Dynasty

*Incumbents of the Delhi Sultanate from **1206 AD** to **1290 AD** are popularly known as the sultans of the Slave dynasty, whose founder was **Qutbuddin Aybak**. *They were all Turks, and their dynasties were separate. *So it is more appropriate to call them the original Turk Sultan or **Mamluk Sultan** of Delhi, instead of calling these sultans as the sultans of the Slave dynasty.

*The first ruler of the Slave Dynasty in India was **Qutbuddin Aybak (1206 - 1210 AD)**. *He was from a Turk tribe called Aybak. *In childhood, he was bought by the Qazi of Nishapur Fakhruddin Abdul Aziz Kufi as a slave. *From childhood he used to read the Quran in a very melodious tone, which made him famous as the **Quran Khwan** (the one who recites the Quran). *Later, he was brought from Nishapur to Ghazni where Ghori bought him. *On the basis of his talent, passion and honesty, he gained the confidence of the Ghori. *Ghori promoted him to the post of **Amir-i-Akhur**. His coronation was held in June 1206 AD, three months after the death of Ghori. *Aybak's capital was **Lahore**. *Aybak never held the title of '**Sultan**'. *He kept himself satisfied only with the titles of '**Malik**' and '**Sipahasalaar**'. *After obtaining the liberation letter from Ghori's successor, Ghiyasuddin Mahmud, Aybak got rid of slavery in **1208 AD**. *Due to his generosity, Qutbuddin Aybak used to donate so much money that he was called by the '**Lakh Bakhsh**' (Giver of lakhs). *Aybak had built mosques known as '**Quwwat-ul-Islam**' in Delhi and '**Adhai Din Ka Jhopra**' in Ajmer. *He started the construction of 'Qutub Minar' in Delhi, which was completed by Iltutmish.

*The fourth Storey was damaged by lightning which was rebuilt by Firuz Shah Tughluq, also spelt **Feroz Shah Tughluq**. He rebuilt the fourth floor of Qutb Minar as well as built the fifth floor. *Sultan Qutbuddin Aybak died in **1210 AD** when he fell from a horse while playing Chaugan (a game like modern polo). *He was buried in Lahore.

* **Iltutmish** received the approval as Sultan not from any Ghor ruler, but from the Khalifa. *Khalifa recognised the rule of Iltutmish to all those areas which he won and gave him the title of 'Sultan-e-Azam'. *Iltutmish was called '**Slave of a slave**' [Aybak (who himself was a slave), whose slave was Iltutmish]. *Iltutmish was a Turk of 'Ilbari' tribe. *Before becoming Sultan, he was the governor of Budaun. *He was with Muhammad Ghori and Aybak during the campaign to suppress the **Khokhar tribe rebellion in 1205 - 1206 AD**. *In the war, Ghori was so influenced by the courage and skill of Aybak that he freed him from slavery.

*Mongol invader Genghis Khan came through the northwest

frontier of India during the reign of Iltutmish. Chasing son of the ruler of Khwarizm Shah, Jalaluddin Mingburni, Genghis Khan reached the bank of Indus river. Jalal-ud-din-Mingburni sought refuge from Iltutmish. Iltutmish dared not to risk the invasion of a dangerous and furious invader like Genghis. So, he prudently refused to give asylum to the Khwarizm. Mongol invasion trouble also went back with Prince Mingburni in 1224 AD. *Iltutmish defeated Hisamuddin Awaz in mountains of Rajmahal near Teliyagarhi and annexed Bihar Sharif and Barh. Awaz had accepted the subordination to Iltutmish. Iltutmish appointed Malik-Jani as the new Subedar of Bihar.

*Iltutmish was the first to use the pure Arabic coins during the Sultanate period in India. He introduced two important coins, i.e. silver (**Tanka**) and copper (Jital) during the Sultanate period and started the tradition of inscribing the name of the Tankshal on the coins. *Iltutmish received a certificate of '**Khilat**' from Caliph of Baghdad in 1229 AD, which made Iltutmish a legitimate Sultan and the Delhi Sultanate an independent state. *It is known from the Ibn Battuta's description that Iltutmish had set up two statues of Lions of marble in front of his palace, which had two bells hanging around their neck which anyone could ring and seek justice from the Sultan. *Iltutmish appointed the officials **Qazi** and **Amir-i-dad** in all the cities. *According to Dr. R. P. Tripathi, the history of Muslim sovereignty in India begins with Iltutmish. * According to Dr. Ishwari Prasad, Iltutmish was, undoubtedly, the founder of Slave Dynasty.

***Raziyya Sultan** (1236-40 AD) was the first female ruler of medieval India. *As an individual, she violated the traditions of Islam for the first time in India, and politically, she emphasized the power to be in the hands of the Sultan instead of dividing it among the Chiefs (Sardars) or the Subedars, and thus, she supported the principle of absolutist dominated monarchy of Iltutmish, which was in the interest of the Turkish Rule at that time. *Turks played an important role in overthrowing Raziyya Begum. *Turks under the leadership of Governor of Bhatinda, **Malik Altunia**, rebelled against Raziyya and overthrew her.

*The full name of Sultan Balban was **Ghiyasuddin Balban**. *Balban ruled the Sultanate from **1266 to 1286 AD** as Sultan. * He was also known as **Ulugh Khan**. *Like Iltutmish, he was also an **Ilbari Turk**. *He laid the foundation of a new dynasty, the Balban Dynasty. *Balban was caught by Mongols in his childhood, who sold him at Ghajini to Khwaja Jamaluddin, a resident of Basra. *He was brought to Delhi in 1232 AD, where Iltutmish bought him in 1233 AD after Gwalior's victory. *Impressed by his abilities, Iltutmish gave him the title of **Khasdaar**. *During the reign of Raziyya, he earned the rank of

Amir-i-Shikar. *In the conspiracy against Raziyya, he was with the Turkish warlords, consequently **Bahramshah** became the Sultan, and Balban got the title of '**Amir-i-Akhur**'. *Due to the grace of Badruddin Rumi, he got the Jagir of Rewari. Alauddin Masudshah became the Sultan with help of Turkish Amirs in which Balban played an important role, consequently he got the Subedari of Hansi. *Balban married his daughter to **Sultan Nasiruddin** in 1249 AD. On this occasion, he was given the title of '**Ulugh Khan**' and the post of '**Nayab-i-mamalikat**'. *Balban sat on Delhi's throne in **1266 AD**.

*It is said about Balban that he adopted a policy of '**blood and iron**'. *There were two main characteristics of the rule of Balban - First the divine right of Sultan and second the Sultan had to be autocratic. *Balban had created his political ideology inspired by the popular heroes of Persia. The King was considered the God's representative on earth - '**Niyamat-i-Khudai**'. *According to him, he is only after the Prophet in the pride and prejudice. *'**Zille Allah**' or '**Zil-i-Ilahi**' means Reflection of God. *He was the first Sultan of Delhi, who established the theory of the state. *He told his son Bugra Khan - "The post of Sultan is a living symbol of autocracy." *Balban started many traditions of the Iranian emperors in his court. He started the rituals of '**Sijada**' (saluting the Sultan in a prostrate manner) and '**Paibos**' (kissing the feet of Sultan). In his court, he started the practice of celebrating the Persian festival '**Nawruz**' with great joy every year. *Balban established a military department '**Diwan-i-Arz**' to combat Mongols. * Balban made **Imad-ul-Mulk** his Military minister (Diwan-i-Arz), who was a very honest and hardworking person. *He kept him free from the financial control of the Wazir so that he did not lack wealth.

1. Who was the founder of Slave dynasty?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------------|
| (a) Iltutmish | (b) Alauddin Khalji |
| (c) Balban | (d) Qutbuddin Aybak |

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

Slave dynasty was the first of five unrelated dynasties to rule India during Sultanate period from 1206 A.D. to 1290 A.D. Qutbuddin Aibak ascended the throne of Delhi Sultanate in 1206 AD and with him started a new line of successive kings in Delhi Sultanate. He was the founder of slave dynasty. Qutbuddin Aibak and all his successors were slaves to their respective predecessors.

2. Who was the first ruler of the Slave Dynasty?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------------|
| (a) Iltutmish | (b) Qutbuddin Aybak |
| (c) Raziyya | (d) Balban |

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The first ruler of the Slave Dynasty (or Ghulam Dynasty) was Qutbuddin Aybak who ruled from 1206 A.D. to 1210 A.D. He established his capital at Lahore. Qutbuddin Aybak was born in Turkistan. Though he was ugly in appearance, he was intelligent and impressive in behaviour. He was taken as a prisoner and sold to the Qazi of Nishapur named Fakhruddin as a slave in his childhood. He was taken care and provided with proper education and military training by the kind-hearted Qazi but soon after the death of the Qazi, his sons sold Aybak to Muhammad Ghori. He was well-versed in Islamic theology, horse riding and swordsmanship. Owing to his skill and qualities, he soon attracted the attention of his master and was appointed commander of a troop. Shortly after battles; he was promoted to the post of Amir-i-Akbar, the master of the royal stable. When Ghori invaded India, Aybak came with his master and provided him with active support during battles. The successes of his master by and large depended on his military skill. Ghori was immensely pleased with him, and he appointed him his governor of the Indian empire. In 1206 A.D., on his way to Ghazni, Ghori died. His empire was inherited by his slaves, as he had no son to succeed him. Aybak, who was a viceroy of his Indian Empire was invited by the Amirs of Lahore to assume the powers. He bestowed the title of Malik and Sipahsalar on himself. Muhammad Ghori had no male successor to inherit his empire; hence his nephew, Ghiyasuddin Mahmud ascended the throne of Ghori after his death in 1206 A.D.

3. Which Sultan of Delhi Sultanate is known as “Lakh Baksh”?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Balban
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (d) Qutbuddin Aybak

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

Sultan Qutbuddin Aybak also called “Lakh Baksh” was the first Muslim ruler of India who ruled from his capital in Lahore. He patronized scholars such as Hasan Nizami and Fakhr-i-Mudabbir, both of whom dedicated their works to Aybak. Aybak was the first muslim ruler who settled in India and ruled unlike the earlier muslims, who came and only raided and plundered. Though his tenure as a ruler was only four years, and most of them were spent in dealing with the revolts of nobles like Taj-ud-din Yalduz, Nasir-ud-din Qabacha and a few Hindu chiefs, yet he established a firm administrative system. He started the construction of Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque at Delhi and Adhai Din ka Jhopra (Ajmer). He also laid the foundation of the Qutub Minar, which was completed by his successor Iltutmish. He was known as Lakh Baksh for his generosity. He never took title of "Sultan" but according to question option (d) is the correct answer

4. What is ‘Adhai Din ka Jhonpra’?

- (a) Mosque
- (b) Temple
- (c) Saint’s hut
- (d) Tower

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

5. Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque and Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra are situated respectively at :

- (a) Delhi and Ajmer
- (b) Delhi and Lahore
- (c) Ajmer and Delhi
- (d) Lahore and Ajmer

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

6. Who among the following did not contribute to building the famous ‘Qutb-Minar’?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aybak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
- (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

Qutbuddin Aybak, the founder of the Delhi Sultanate, started construction of the Qutub Minar, which was completed by Iltutmish. The topmost storey was damaged by lightning, which was rebuilt by Firuz Shah Tughluq. Firuz Shah Tughluq rebuilt the fourth floor of Qutub Minar and built the fifth floor. Ghiyasuddin Tughluq contributed nothing to its construction. From the above options, option (c) is the correct answer.

7. The Qutub Minar was completed by :

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Qutb-ud-din Aibak
- (c) Ulugh Khan
- (d) Raziya Sultana
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

8. The capital of Qutbuddin Aybak was

- (a) Lahore
- (b) Delhi
- (c) Ajmer
- (d) Lakhnauti

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

After the death of Muhammad Ghori in 1206 A.D., his General Qutbuddin Aybak, who was in charge of Lahore and north-Indian possessions, was invited by Amirs of Lahore to assume the powers of Ghori. The capital of Qutbuddin Aybak was Lahore. Taj-ud-Din Yalduz, Governor of Kirman ascended the throne of Ghazni. It seems that it was the

desire of Muhammad Ghori that Qutbuddin Aybak should succeed him in India. In his brief reign of four years (1206-10 A.D.), he moved his capital to Lahore to frustrate Yalduz's ambition of annexing Punjab. He strengthened his position by matrimonial alliances with influential rival Turkish Chiefs. Nasiruddin Qabacha of Multan refused to accept Qutbuddin as the ruler of Delhi Sultanate. Due to this, Aybak always stayed in Lahore and never got the chance to move to Delhi.

9. How did Sultan Qutbuddin Aybak die?

- (a) He was treacherously stabbed to death by one of his ambitious nobles
- (b) He was killed in a battle with Taj-ud-din Yalduz the ruler of Ghazni who entered into a contest with him over the capture of Punjab
- (c) He sustained injuries while besieging the fortress of Kalinjar in Bundelkhand and succumbed to them later
- (d) He died after a fall from his horse while playing Chaugan

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

In 1210 A.D., Qutbuddin Aybak died in an accident while he was playing Chaugan (polo). He fell from a horse and was severely injured. He was buried in Lahore near the Anarkali Bazaar. He was the founder of the Slave Dynasty in India.

10. Who among the following established Delhi as the capital of Sultanate?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aybak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Raziyya
- (d) Muizzuddin Ghori

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

Iltutmish (1211-36 AD) was the real founder of the Delhi Sultanate. Before this, Aybak ruled from Lahore. He is said to have introduced first Arabic silver (175 grain) and copper currency which were two basic coins of the Sultanate period. In 1229 A.D., Iltutmish got recognition as the Muslim Sultan of India by the Caliph of Baghdad. Iltutmish, after that, assumed the title of 'Amir-ul- Mommini' or 'Commander of the faithful' and had the name of Khalifa inscribed on his coins. This was a great achievement of his life.

11. Who was the first Sultan of Delhi who introduced regular coins and declared Delhi the capital of his empire?

- (a) Nasiruddin Mahmud
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Aram Shah
- (d) Balban

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

12. Which one of the following was the capital of the Sultanate during the reign of Iltutmish?

- (a) Agra
- (b) Lahore
- (c) Badaun
- (d) Delhi

U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Iltutmish shifted his capital from Lahore to Delhi. He was the first Sultan of the Sultanate to shift his capital.

13. Who among the following Sultans of the Sultanate was the first to shift his capital to Delhi?

- (a) Aram Shah
- (b) Balban
- (c) Iltutmish
- (d) Qutbuddin Aybak

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

14. Who was the first Muslim ruler of Delhi?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aybak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Raziyya
- (d) Balban

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

Iltutmish was the first Sultan of Delhi who received the investiture from Caliph. In 1229 A.D., the Caliph of Baghdad, Al-Muntasir Billah, bestowed on Iltutmish the title of "Sultan-i- Azam" or the Sultan The Great. Thus, in this way, he was the first legally independent Sultan of Delhi. He was successful in keeping the throne of Delhi safe from the danger of Mongol invasion as well as from the attacks of both Taj ud-din Yalduz and Qabacha. He broke up the Rajput powers in the north and established his supremacy over them. He made his rule hereditary, issued coins with his name and made Delhi a beautiful capital. He is said to have introduced first Arabic silver (175gm) and copper currency which were two basic coins of the Sultanate period. Iltutmish belonged to the tribe of 'Ilbari' in the Eurasian Steppe of Turkestan. Iltutmish was first appointed governor of Badaun in recognition of his services during the campaign of Muhammad of Ghur against the Khokhars in 1205-06 A.D. Amirali Ismail invited Iltutmish for the coronation in Delhi with the approval of Turkish nobles after the death of Aybak. Iltutmish declared himself Sultan in 1211 A.D.

15. The Muslim ruler whose empire was regarded as a part of Dar-ul-Islam was :

- (a) Balban
- (b) Razia
- (c) Iltutmish
- (d) Nasir-ud-Din
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (c)

During the period of Iltutmish, in 1229 A.D. the Caliph of Baghdad gave khillat to Iltutmish. Now the Sultanate theoretically became part of Dar-ul-Islam subject to the caliph of Baghdad.

16. Who was called 'a slave of a slave'?

- (a) Mohd. Ghorī (b) Qutbuddin Aybak
(c) Balban (d) Iltutmish

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Iltutmish is called 'A Slave of a Slave' because Qutbuddin Aybak was the slave of Muhammad. Ghorī, who became Sultan after the death of Ghorī, and Iltutmish, was a slave of Qutbuddin Aybak, who later married the daughter of Qutbuddin Aybak and became Sultan.

17. Who among the following was not the rivals of Iltutmish?

- (a) Tajuddin Yalduz (b) Nasiruddin Qabacha
(c) Ali Mardan (d) Malik Altunia

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

In the given options, Malik Altunia was not the rival of Iltutmish. His main rivals included Tajuddin Yalduz in Gazhāni, Nasiruddin Qabacha in Sindh and Ali Mardan in Lakhnauti. Iltutmish was a slave of Qutbuddin Aybak and after Aram Shah's death took control of the Delhi Sultanate as independent ruler.

18. Who of the following was the first woman ruler of medieval India ?

- (a) Raziyya Sultan (b) Chand Bibi
(c) Durgavati (d) Noorjahan

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (a)

Raziyya Sultan, who reigned from 1236 to 1240 A.D., had the unique distinction of being the only woman to occupy the throne of Delhi Sultanate. She was the first female ruler of Delhi Sultanate. The Turkish nobles were reluctant to accept a woman as their ruler, especially when she challenged their power.

19. During whose reign Mongol invader Genghis Khan came through the North-West Frontier of India?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji (b) Iltutmish
(c) Balban (d) Aybak

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Mongol invader Genghis Khan came through the northwest frontier of India during the reign of Iltutmish. Chasing son of the ruler of Khawarizm Shah, Jalaluddin Mingburni.

Genghis Khan reached the bank of Indus river. Jalal-ud-din-Mingburni sought refuge from Iltutmish. Iltutmish dared not risk the invasion by a dangerous and furious invader like Genghis. So, he prudently refused to give asylum to the Mingburni. Mongol invasion trouble also went back with Prince Mingburni in 1224 AD

20. Which Sultan of Delhi was a contemporary of the Mongol Leader Genghis Khan ?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Raziyya
(c) Balban (d) Alauddin Khalji

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

21. In whose reign Mongols were seen on the bank of Indus river for the first time?

- (a) Balban (b) Iltutmish
(c) Qutbuddin Aybak (d) Raziyya

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

22. The Mongols under Genghis Khan invaded India during the reign of :

- (a) Balban (b) Firuz Tughluq
(c) Iltutmish (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

I.A.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

23. The original name of Changez (Genghis) Khan was

- (a) Khasul Khan (b) Yesugai
(c) Temuchin (Temujin) (d) Ogadi

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Genghis Khan was a Mongolian ruler who played a significant role in Mongolian imperial expansion. The original name of Genghis Khan was Temujin (or Temuchin).

24. Consider the following statements :

1. It was during the reign of Iltutmish that Chengiz Khan reached the Indus in pursuit of the fugitive Khwarezm prince.
2. It was during the reign of Muhammad bin Tughluq that Taimur occupied Multan and crossed the Indus.
3. It was during the reign of Deva Raya II of Vijayanagara Empire that Vasco da Gama reached the coast of Kerala

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

During the reign of Iltutmish, Genghis Khan pursued Khwarizm prince Jalaluddin, who fled to Delhi. Iltutmish refused the request for the asylum of prince, hence statement 1 is correct. Taimur started his career of conquest in 1370 A.D. while Muhammad bin Tughluq's time period was 1325-1351 A.D., hence Statement (2) is wrong. During the reign of Deva Rai II of Vijayanagara, Iranian ambassador Abdur Razzaq came to Vijayanagara. Vasco-da-Gama reached coast of Kerala in 1498 AD. At that time, Vijayanagara was being ruled by Narsa Nayaka's son Timma. Hence statement (3) is also wrong.

25. Iltutmish appointed his first Subedar in Bihar to :

- (a) Aivaj (b) Nasiruddin Mahmud
(c) Alimardan (d) Malik - Jani

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

In 1225 A.D., Iltutmish defeated Hisamuddin Awaz in mountains of Rajmahal near Teliyagarhi and annexed Bihar Shareef and Barh. Awaz had accepted the subordination of Iltutmish. Iltutmish had appointed Malik-Jani as the new Subedar of Bihar.

26. Who was behind the dethroning of Raziyya Begum?

- (a) Afghans (b) Mongols
(c) Turks (d) Arabs

U. P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Turkish nobles were behind dethroning of Raziyya Begum. They revolted against Raziyya Begum under the leadership of governor of Bhatinda, Malik Altunia and removed her from the power.

27. The full name of Sultan of Delhi Balban was?

- (a) Jalaluddin (b) Iltutmish
(c) Ghiyasuddin (d) Qutbuddin

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

The full name of Balban was Ghiyasuddin Balban. He was the ninth Sultan of the Mamluk dynasty of Delhi. Ghiyasuddin was the Wazeer and heir of the last Shamsi Sultan, Nasiruddin Mahmud. He reduced the power of the treacherous nobility and heightened the stature of the Sultan. In spite of having only a few military achievements, he was the most powerful ruler of the Sultanate between Shamsuddin Iltutmish and

Alauddin Khalji. He reached on the post of Amir-i-Shikar during Raziyya period. Like Iltutmish, he also was an Ilbari Turk. Balban married his daughter to Sultan Nasiruddin, on this occasion was given the title of Ulugh Khan and the post of Nayab-i- Mamlakat. Balban sat on the throne of Delhi in 1266 A.D.

28. Which Sultan of Delhi is said to have followed the policy of "blood and iron"?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Jalaluddin Firuz Khalji (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

It is said that Balban had adopted the policy of 'blood and iron.' The main characteristics of the leadership of Balban were- First, the divine right of kings and second, the Sultan must be autocratic. According to him, "Sultan is a representative of God (Niyamat-i-Khudai) on earth and his place comes after Paigambar. Sultan gets the inspiration and strength from God to work. Due to this, the public and the Sardars have no right to criticize his work."

29. Which Delhi Sultan is known for adopting the 'blood and iron' policy?

- (a) Iltutmish
(b) Balban
(c) Ala-ud-din Khalji
(d) Muhammad bin Tughluq
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans (b)

See the explanation of above question

30. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A) : Balban made his government firm stable and centralized all authority in his hands.

Reason (R) : He wanted to protect North-West frontier against Mongol invasions.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

Ghiyasuddin Balban was the ruler of the Slave Dynasty in Delhi Sultanate. He ruled from 1266 to 1286 A.D. He assumed the title of emperor as a divine act of God and took all the powers into his hands. He introduced the custom of Sijada and Paibos. He constructed strong forts at the northwest border to defend from the attacks of Mongols. Assertion (A) and reason (R) both are correct, but Reason (R) is not the correct explanation of Assertion (A).

31. Below are two statements, one of which is an Assertion (A) and the other is a Reason (R):

Assertion (A): Balban made his government firm and centralized all authority in his hands.

Reason (R): He wanted to secure the northwestern border from Mongol invasions.

Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
- (c) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

32. After consolidating his power, Balban assumed the grand title of

- (a) Tuti-e-Hind
- (b) Kaiser-e-Hind
- (c) Zil-e-Ilahi
- (d) Din-e-Ilahi

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Balban established his political model inspired by famed public heroes. He tried to provide a highly respected reputation to his reign. He was considered the representative of God (Niyamat-e-Khudai) on the earth. According to Balban, he comes after Paigambar in dignity. The king is 'Zill-e-Allah' or 'Zil-i-Ilahi' means 'Image of God.' Balban was the first Sultan, who had established kingship theory. He told his son- "The position of Sultan is the symbol of autocracy."

33. Who was the first Muslim ruler to formulate the 'theory of kingship' similar to the 'theory of divine right of the kings'?

- (a) Aibak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Balban
- (d) Alauddin

(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans (c)

Balban was the first ruler to propound the 'theory of Kingship' similar to the 'theory of divine right of the kings. He said, "Sultan is representative of God on earth and his place comes after Paigambar".

34. Who among the following introduced the famous Persian festival 'Nawruz' in India?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Firuz Tughluq
- (d) Alauddin Khalji

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

Balban made some rules and regulations for his court and strictly enforced them. Iranian kings were his ideals in this field, and he introduced many of their traditions in his court. He introduced the rituals of Sijada (greeting lying on the ground) and Paibos (kissing the feet of the king). He also introduced the rituals to celebrate the Persian festival 'Nawruz.'

35. Who among the following introduced the Persian festival Nawruz in India?

- (a) Firuz Shah Tughlaq
- (b) Alauddin Khilji
- (c) Balban
- (d) Iltutmish

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

36. Which one of the following statements is not true about Balban?

- (a) He propounded the theory of Niyabat-e-Khudai.
- (b) He introduced the Iqtadari System.
- (c) He eliminated the power of Turkan-e-Chahalgani.
- (d) He quelled down the revolt of Bengal.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The actual name of Balban was Baha-ud-din. Nasiruddin Mahmud had given him the title of 'Ulugh Khan'. He assumed the title 'Zil-i-Ilahi'. His tenure was from 1266 to 1286 A.D. Balban is famous for his reign theory. His royal principle of nature and essence was inspired by Persian reign. Balban described the king as 'Niyamat-e-Khudai' (representative of God). After attaining the power, he abolished the 'Turkan-e-Chahalgani', established by Iltutmish. The only revolt in the period of Balban was done by Subedar of Bengal, Tughril Khan in 1279 A.D., which was quelled by Balban and the rebels were hanged. The system of Iqtadari was introduced by Iltutmish.